Cite as: Spytska L: Altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the sensation of déjà vu.
Psychiatr Psychol Klin 2026; 26 (3): 294–302

Received: 28.02.2025
Accepted: 28.07.2025
Published: 29.10.2026

Liana Spytska

Altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the sensation of déjà vu

Zmienione stany świadomości, intuicja i uczucie déjà vu

Department of Psychology and Pedagogy, Kyiv International University, Kyiv, Ukraine
Correspondence: Liana Spytska, Department of Psychology and Pedagogy, Kyiv International University, Lvivska 49, 03179 Kyiv, Ukraine, e-mail: spytskalli@ukr.net

https://doi.org/10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

ORCID iD
Liana Spytska https://orcid.org/0009-0005-2624-5254

Abstract

Introduction and objective: Altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the sensation of déjà vu reveal various aspects and possibilities of human consciousness. Studying these phenomena is relevant today, as it helps understand how the human mental system operates, what processes occur in the brain, and how they affect the perception of reality. The purpose of this study is to examine the occurrence, mechanisms, and impact of altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu on human experience. **Materials and methods:** The article adopts an interdisciplinary theoretical and analytical approach, drawing on data from psychology, cognitive science, neuroscience, and philosophy. It reviews current research and uses conceptual generalisation to analyse the mechanisms underlying altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the phenomenon of déjà vu. **Results:** The study carefully analyses and highlights the features of several types of intuition that determine human decision-making. In particular, "intuition-guesswork", "intuition that reveals something new", and "fundamental intuition" were examined, and each was found to play a significant role in forming the psychological foundation for the decision-making process. According to the results of the analysis, this emotionally charged impression occurs due to incorrect reconstruction of events in memory. **Conclusions:** The study findings can be used in various fields, such as psychology, medicine, education, and the arts. In particular, they can be useful for improving teaching methods, treating mental disorders, or developing creative potential.

Keywords: stabilisation exercises, cognitive process, psychology, psychostimulants, intense emotions

Streszczenie

Wprowadzenie i cel: Zmienione stany świadomości, intuicja i uczucie *déjà vu* ujawniają różne aspekty oraz możliwości ludzkiej świadomości, a ich badanie jest dziś istotne, ponieważ pomaga zrozumieć, jak działa ludzki umysł, jakie procesy zachodzą w mózgu i jak wpływają one na postrzeganie świata. Celem pracy było zbadanie występowania, mechanizmów i wpływu zmienionych stanów świadomości, intuicji i *déjà vu* na ludzkie doświadczenie. **Materiał i metody:** Zastosowano interdyscyplinarne podejście teoretyczne i analityczne, wykorzystując dane z psychologii, kognitywistyki, neuronauki i filozofii. Dokonano przeglądu aktualnych badań i zastosowano uogólnienie koncepcyjne do analizy mechanizmów odmiennych stanów świadomości, intuicji i zjawiska *déjà vu*. **Wyniki:** W pracy dokładnie przeanalizowano i podkreślono cechy różnych rodzajów intuicji, które determinują podejmowanie decyzji przez daną osobę. W szczególności rozważono „intuicję–domysł", „intuicję, która odkrywa coś nowego" oraz „intuicję fundamentalną" i stwierdzono, że odgrywają one znaczącą rolę w tworzeniu psychologicznych podstaw procesu podejmowania decyzji. Zgodnie z wynikami analizy stwierdzono, że to zabarwione emocjonalnie wrażenie powstaje w wyniku nieprawidłowej rekonstrukcji wydarzeń w pamięci. Takie zniekształcenie może wystąpić pod wpływem różnych czynników, w tym zmęczenia, stresu i cech pamięci. **Wnioski:** Uzyskane wyniki mogą być wykorzystane w różnych dziedzinach, takich jak psychologia, medycyna, edukacja i sztuka, w szczególności mogą być przydatne do ulepszania metod nauczania, leczenia zaburzeń psychicznych lub rozwijania potencjału twórczego.

Słowa kluczowe: ćwiczenia stabilizacyjne, proces poznawczy, psychologia, psychostymulanty, intensywne emocje

© 2026 Medical Communication Sp. z o.o. This is an open-access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivatives License (CC BY-NC-ND). Reproduction is permitted for personal, educational, non-commercial use, provided that the original article is in whole, unmodified, and properly cited.
Author: Spytska L. Proofreading by ENSKA Agnieszka Kosarzycka.

INTRODUCTION

Déjà vu (from French "already seen") is a cognitive phenomenon characterised by the subjective impression that a current situation, event, or experience has already occurred in the past, despite the awareness that this sense of familiarity cannot be attributed to an actual memory. It represents a disruption in the normal processes of memory encoding and retrieval, often involving the erroneous recognition of a novel experience as something previously lived.

The investigation of altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the sensation of déjà vu offers valuable insights into the subjective dimensions of human experience. These phenomena shed light on how individuals perceive the world, make decisions, and regulate behaviour. Their study contributes to a deeper understanding of the functioning of the brain and psyche, and supports the development of psychological theories related to cognition, perception, and consciousness. However, the inherently subjective and transient nature of these experiences presents methodological challenges. In particular, research on altered states of consciousness often requires special ethical considerations and access to specific populations, which may complicate empirical work.

The study by Bezverkhy (2020) explores the concept of altered states of consciousness, emphasising how they differ from the normal state of wakefulness. The author identifies several types of altered states, including trance, relaxation, and expanded consciousness, and investigates their potential applications in practical psychology. According to the researcher, such states may serve multiple purposes, such as supporting self-knowledge, treating mental disorders, and fostering the development of individual potentials. The study highlights the importance of understanding these states in more depth, particularly their relationship to phenomena such as intuition and déjà vu, and suggests that further exploration in these areas may yield valuable insights into human consciousness and its therapeutic applications.

Donets (2021) investigates the phenomenon of intuition, defining it as a sudden leap in perception and understanding. This leap occurs when accumulated experience and logical thinking transition into a new qualitative level of perception. The study emphasises intuition as "intellectual insight" or "intuitive insight", in which knowledge emerges without logical substantiation or proof. Donets examines intuition as the perception of truth or essence that bypasses consistent reasoning. The research highlights that intuitive knowledge may appear unexpectedly, without intellectual analysis, and does not require prior questions or goals to be formulated.

Perrin et al. (2022) explore the phenomenon of déjà vu, emphasising that it creates the impression that a current event or situation is intertwined with previous experiences, even when such a connection is absent. The study identifies déjà vu as a broader aspect of temporal experience, suggesting that it enables individuals to view events from an alternative perspective. The authors highlight the need for further exploration of this state of consciousness to gain a deeper understanding of its mechanisms and significance.

Cleary and Brown (2021) examine the neurological basis of déjà vu, suggesting that it may result from the incorrect reconstruction of events in memory. The study identifies the involvement of specific brain regions, including the hippocampus and parietal lobes, in the perception and processing of information. Disruptions in these neural areas can distort the temporal sequence of events, producing the sensation of déjà vu. The authors emphasise the need for further research into how déjà vu functions at both the psychological and neurological levels, particularly its effects on memory processes and perception.

Rehabilitation measures are important for individuals suffering from addiction to psychoactive substances that alter the state of consciousness, as argued by Halych (2022). The researcher emphasises that such substances can affect both the physical and psychological condition of a person. Rehabilitation is therefore crucial for supporting individuals with addiction, as it aims to restore normal states of consciousness and psychophysical health, highlighting the need for further investigation into rehabilitation and stabilisation processes in the context of altered states of consciousness.

Despite the important conclusions drawn from existing studies, a number of questions regarding altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the phenomenon of déjà vu remain unresolved. In particular, the mechanisms through which these states influence cognitive processes and decision-making, as well as their interaction with neuropsychological processes in the brain, are not yet fully understood. In addition, existing studies do not sufficiently address specific methods and techniques that can be used to study these phenomena in psychological practice, particularly in rehabilitation and psychotherapy. These issues require further investigation to gain a deeper understanding of their impact on mental health and brain function.

The aim of the present study is to investigate the mechanisms of altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu, as well as their impact on human perception and cognitive processes. Within the framework of this study, the following tasks are set:

- to analyse neuropsychological aspects of altered states of consciousness;
- to investigate the role of intuition in decision-making and perception;
- to study the neuropsychological mechanisms of déjà vu and their impact on memory and temporal perception.

The criteria for selecting sources focused on recent, peer-reviewed research addressing altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu, emphasising psychological, cognitive, and neurobiological aspects. The selected sources were evaluated for scientific rigor, methodological soundness, and relevance to the research questions. Only studies that contributed substantial theoretical or empirical insight into the mechanisms underlying these phenomena, or

 DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

provided a comprehensive analysis of their effects on human consciousness, were included. Preference was given sources demonstrating methodological clarity and employing well-established research methods, including empirical studies, systematic reviews, and meta-analyses. The selection process also considered the diversity of perspectives and approaches across various disciplines (psychology, neuroscience, and philosophy) to ensure a multifaceted understanding of the phenomena under investigation.

Regarding the methods of analysis, the study employed a systematic approach to synthesising findings from the selected literature. This involved coding and categorising key themes and concepts to identify common trends, differences, and gaps in the existing body of knowledge. Particular attention was given to the methodological frameworks used across the studies, enabling a comparative analysis of their approaches and results. The analysis was conducted with the aim of integrating diverse viewpoints into a cohesive narrative, providing a comprehensive examination of altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu. For greater transparency and methodological rigour, a detailed description of the selection criteria and analytical procedures would further enhance the clarity and reliability of the research design. By describing the process in greater detail, the study can provide a clear justification for the sources selected and demonstrate the robustness of the analytical methods applied. This would contribute to a more transparent and reproducible approach to studying these complex psychological and neurobiological phenomena.

MAIN ASPECTS AND COMPONENTS OF CONSCIOUSNESS IN HUMAN EXPERIENCE

The phenomena of altered states of human consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu constitute an important area of modern psychological science, as they evoke mixed reactions that raise questions among both researchers and the general public. In everyday life, the experience of altered states of consciousness, déjà vu, and intuition can have a significant impact on a person's daily functioning and perception of the world. Altered states of consciousness include phenomena in which a person feels that their consciousness is being separated from their usual state. These experiences may arise from a variety of factors, including stress, panic attacks, substance use, and other influences. Understanding such conditions can help improve psychological health and quality of life. In contrast, intuition is a mental resource that enables making decisions and drawing conclusions based on an inner sense that is not always supported by rational evidence. Intuitive thinking plays an important role in understanding complex situations and making decisions. The sensation of déjà vu, in turn, is marked by the feeling that a current situation or event has already been experienced before, even when this does not correspond to actual memory. This phenomenon raises important questions about the nature of memory and perception.

Human consciousness refers to a person's ability to reflect internally and externally on the surrounding world, events, and various aspects of life (Nibbio et al., 2025). It allows individuals to make sense of the world around them and create their own beliefs and attitudes toward these phenomena. Consciousness is the highest level of mental reflection, inherent only to humans as social beings (Zotaj et al., 2024). It covers knowledge of both external and internal aspects of reality and self-awareness. Consciousness extends beyond mere knowledge of the surrounding reality. It also encompasses evaluative judgments, theoretical perspectives, and practical attitudes toward these phenomena.

Thus, one of the most important components of consciousness is also how individuals experience what they consider meaningful in the world around them. Consciousness functions as a tool of the cognitive process within a concept that considers various long-term and qualitative modes or states of consciousness that may occur over time (Overgaard and Overgaard, 2010). This concept emphasises that in altered states of consciousness, when specific feelings arise, intuition and déjà vu may manifest themselves in a variety of ways, depending on the circumstances and context, and have distinct qualitative characteristics.

Human consciousness consists of several important elements, including perception, awareness, attention, memory, thinking, emotions, self-awareness, and time perception (Nazarova et al., 2024). Perception is the process of receiving external and internal stimuli, such as sounds, smells, sensations, thoughts, and emotions, and enables individuals to gain information about the world (Aftab et al., 2024; Efremov, 2025b). Awareness refers to understanding information obtained through perception; it involves processing information and making decisions. Attention determines what exactly consciousness is focused on at a particular moment. It helps concentrate on certain aspects of the world around and filter out other stimuli.

Memory allows individuals to store information and use it in the future. It includes short-term, long-term, and procedural memory. Thinking includes logical understanding, analysis, synthesis, and intellectual abilities, enabling individuals to solve problems, draw conclusions, and generate new ideas. Emotions shape a person's perception and reactions to events and situations, including joy, anger, fear, sadness, and other feelings (Efremov, 2025a). Self-awareness allows individuals to understand themselves, their beliefs, values, and identity. Consciousness also involves the perception of time and the ability to understand the sequence of events. These elements interact with one another, forming a complex integrated process that enables individuals to perceive, understand, and interact with the world around them.

Altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu can influence various elements of consciousness. Altered states may affect perception and awareness, changing how people perceive and understand their environment. Intuition

DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

is related to thinking and awareness, involving logical decisions and understanding of certain situations, and the ability to generate new ideas. Feelings of déjà vu can influence memory and time perception. People who experience déjà vu may have the impression that events have already happened, which can affect their perception of time and memory. Thus, altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu can influence different aspects of consciousness and manifest across its various components.

Given the complexity of the phenomena of altered states of consciousness, intuition, and déjà vu, it is necessary to consider their subjectivity and variability, which may differ from person to person. It is important to emphasise that these phenomena can have different manifestations in the life of each individual. The emphasis on an individual approach to understanding these phenomena contributes to a deeper examination of the functioning of human consciousness and the psyche in a general context. The study of these phenomena from psychological and neuroscientific perspectives opens up the possibility of gaining a deeper understanding of how people in a state of altered consciousness, with a sense of intuition and déjà vu, feel and perceive the world around them. By analysing these phenomena, researchers can employ advanced methods such as imaginative thinking and functional magnetic resonance imaging to study correlations between brain activity and sensations associated with altered states of consciousness. Research in this area may reveal new approaches to the treatment of mental disorders linked to altered states of consciousness. Considering individual characteristics of reactions to these phenomena allows the development of personalised approaches to psychotherapy and psychiatric treatment. Such detailed individualised analysis can help refine support strategies and improve the quality of life for individuals experiencing similar states of consciousness.

ALTERED STATES OF CONSCIOUSNESS: PSYCHOLOGICAL ASPECTS AND THEIR IMPACT ON THE HUMAN PSYCHE

Altered states of consciousness refer to conditions in which the functioning of consciousness differs from the normal state of wakefulness. These states include, but are not limited to, deep meditative contemplation, states caused by substance use, dreaming, and deep relaxation. Altered states of consciousness may arise from various influences, such as physical, psychological, or pharmacological factors. One of the aspects that should be considered is the influence of altered states on physiological and mental processes. For example, during a deep meditative state, there may be a decrease in the activity of the sympathetic nervous system and an increase in the activity of the parasympathetic nervous system, leading to changes in heart rate and blood circulation. It is also important to investigate the psychological aspects of altered states of consciousness, particularly their impact on perception and understanding of the surrounding world. It is believed that there is an opportunity to improve creativity and intuitive thinking during certain altered states of consciousness.

Psychostimulants (psychoactive substances) such as lysergic acid diethylamide (LSD), mescaline, psilocybin, ibogaine, phencyclidine, ketamine, and amphetamine derivatives are well-known agents capable of inducing altered states of consciousness. Minor psychostimulants, including ethyl alcohol (ethanol), tobacco, theobromine, khat, and caffeine, can also affect consciousness and cause changes in mental state. Notably, the use of these substances can cause different reactions in the body, and these effects can vary depending on the dose, frequency, and individual characteristics of each person. Rehabilitation is a key tool for individuals struggling with addiction to substances that can affect consciousness and cause changes in their perception of the world. Rehabilitation programmes have the potential to be effective and help overcome addiction, and restore a stable state of consciousness. Various methods and approaches to rehabilitation allow tailoring treatment programmes to the specific circumstances and needs of each person (Fletcher, 2013).

It is important to note the close relationship between different brain regions, which may change dynamically under the influence of altered states of consciousness, such as those induced by LSD use. LSD is a psychoactive substance that causes dramatic changes in consciousness and perception (Moses et al., 2024). Under the influence of LSD, significant changes in brain activity are observed. Research shows that LSD affects the functioning of multiple brain areas, including those responsible for processing visual information, emotional responses, and regulating mood. These changes can occur due to effects on the serotonin system, which plays a key role in mood regulation and information processing. In addition, LSD may stimulate the formation of new connections between neurons, which can affect the perception and processing of information. These changes in brain activity may explain the vivid visual phenomena and altered states of consciousness experienced under the influence of LSD (Preller et al., 2019).

Altered states of consciousness open up the possibility for scientific research into how global changes in brain activity relate to various aspects of subjective experience. These states share common characteristics that indicate a potentially unified mechanism. They are often long-lasting and usually reversible, though not always. Altered states of consciousness are not determined by specific subjective experiences but rather by general qualitative changes in the content of consciousness, including variations in intensity. These states can be organised into different levels, ranging from "reduced" states of consciousness, such as general anaesthesia or sleep, to more "deep" states, such as those occurring during meditation or under the influence of pharmacological substances. This diversity enables the study of a wide range of phenomena that occur in altered states of consciousness and allows researchers to examine their impact on mental states and experiences (Cofré et al., 2020).

 DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

No.	Exercise	Purpose	Description of the technique
1	5-4-3-2-1	This technique aims to activate five different sensory modalities (vision, touch, hearing, smell, and taste) and helps focus and return to reality	Using vision, the person identifies and names five objects, carefully observing their details, including colour, shade, and size. Next, they focus on four tactile sensations, such as the feel of clothing on the skin, the warmth of the sun, the texture of a chair, or jewellery such as a chain or ring. Next, they activate hearing by identifying and distinguishing three different sounds, paying attention to their pitch, timbre, and volume, such as the sound of a car, birdsong, people's voices, or a heartbeat. Afterwards, they focus on two smells in the environment, such as the smell of air, the scent of perfume, or the aroma of coffee. Finally, they identify one taste, such as tea, water, candy, or lemon.
2	Radio	Helps control obsessive thoughts, voices, and emotions	The person begins a cognitive process by imagining a situation where disturbing thoughts or memories are signals from an imaginary radio and do not belong to the person. They mentally locate the volume control on the device and turn the volume down or even switch it off entirely. It is possible to change channels until the person finds one that contains pleasant signals and does not cause negative emotions.
3	Who am I?	Provides the opportunity to focus on the present moment and return to reality	After recalling any information about themselves, the person should express it out loud (for example, "My name is Anna, I am a woman, I am 29 years old. Today is Monday, 6 November 2023. I work as a stylist and I am now in a coffee shop, sitting on a chair in the hall; in front of me is a cup of coffee"). Various details can be added to this information until the person feels that they are returning to reality.
4	Visualisation	Allows breaking away from unwanted thoughts and feelings, and focusing on pleasant imagery	During this exercise, the person remembers or imagines the most pleasant memories or dreams. It is necessary to involve all the senses, trying to feel all the colours of nature and the world around, listen to sounds, feel and touch different surfaces, inhale smells, and experience tastes. It is worth continuing this exercise as long as it provides distraction from negative thoughts, pleasant positive emotions appear, the muscles relax, and the person performing the exercise starts to feel calm.
Source: compiled by the author based on Zaika (2023).			

Tab. 1. Exercises for stabilisation in altered states of consciousness

The group approach in the treatment of dependence on substances that change the state of consciousness is highly effective in contemporary clinical practice. Group therapy, widely used to solve addiction problems, has proven effective and is recognised as one of the key therapeutic modalities. Individuals experiencing an altered state of consciousness for various reasons, including taking various psychostimulants, may receive effective therapy in both group and individual formats. Group therapy can be particularly useful for people who share similar experiences with other group members (Dykha et al., 2024). In this format, individuals can share their experiences, talk about their feelings, and find common ground with others who are also experiencing altered states of consciousness. Group therapy can provide support and a sense of belonging to participants and help them cope with their problems. Participation in group therapy offers patients the opportunity to receive support from like-minded people who are following a similar recovery path. Collaborative efforts and sharing experiences within a safe group environment contribute to creating a positive social influence, which can be particularly valuable in the context of substance dependence, which is often determined by social factors (Mukhammedov et al., 2024). Group therapy also enables professionals to implement a variety of treatments, such as cognitive-behavioural therapy, supportive therapy, and mutual-aid strategies. This integrated approach allows tailoring treatment to the individual needs of each group member (Coco et al., 2019). Group therapy is an effective tool in the rehabilitation of individuals with substance dependence, contributing to their physical, mental, and social recovery (Dufynets et al., 2024).

Individual therapy is aimed at addressing the personal problems and needs of each individual client. This format allows the therapist to work on the individual needs of the client and provide personalised care. During individual therapy, various psychotherapeutic approaches can be used, including cognitive behavioural therapy, psychoanalysis, or Gestalt therapy, depending on the needs and nature of the client's difficulties. Both approaches can be useful for maintaining and restoring mental health in people who have experienced altered states of consciousness. It is important to choose the approach that best fits the needs and unique situation of each client.

In situations where a person experiences extremely intense emotions that they are unable to manage, it is critical to use psychological first-aid techniques to help them return to reality and prevent negative consequences (Tab. 1). These conditions include severe stress, shock, panic attacks, increased anxiety, obsessive thoughts and memories, flashbacks in post-traumatic stress disorder, pain associated with acute and chronic somatic diseases, fears and phobias, suicidal or self-aggressive thoughts, uncontrolled manifestations of aggression, depression, insomnia, stupor, and other conditions.

The exercises suggested for stabilising consciousness are important self-regulation tools that can help individuals experiencing altered states of consciousness restore emotional balance and regain orientation in reality. They are aimed at reducing disorientation, lowering stress and anxiety levels, and improving a person's ability to control their emotions and perceptions. In the context of altered states of consciousness, such as depersonalisation, panic attacks, or states induced by psychoactive substances, these exercises help stabilise the psycho-emotional state, helping the person return to their current physical and psychological state. In particular, techniques such as "5-4-3-2-1" or "Radio"

DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

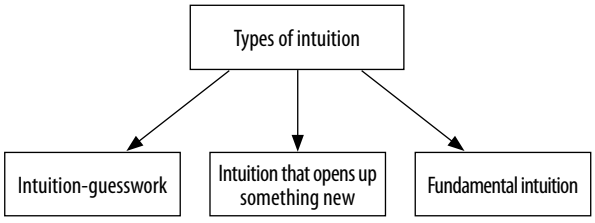


Fig. 1. Three types of intuition

activate sensory attention and help reduce the intensity of negative experiences that arise during altered states of consciousness, increasing the ability to adapt and respond consciously to environmental stimuli.

Such exercises form an important part of psychotherapeutic practices, as they foster awareness and reduce the risk of developing more serious psychological disorders. Scientific research confirms the effectiveness of these self-regulation methods in stabilising consciousness during extreme psycho-emotional states. For example, Zaika (2023) demonstrated that attention-focusing and sensory integration techniques can be particularly useful for individuals experiencing altered states of consciousness, enabling them to restore normal interaction with reality. This, in turn, underscores the importance of including such exercises in treatment and rehabilitation strategies.

Mastering the techniques of self-regulation in psychology enhances the ability to support oneself and others in situations where the consciousness is in an altered state, and also helps disengage from unpleasant or destructive thoughts and emotions that may suddenly arise and dominate mental experience.

INTUITION: PSYCHOLOGICAL PROCESSES AND INFLUENCE ON DECISION-MAKING IN THE CONTEXT OF ALTERED STATES OF CONSCIOUSNESS

Intuition refers to knowledge that arises without awareness of the ways and conditions of acquiring it at the cognitive level, as it develops through unconscious experience, without directed influence. Intuition means the ability to grasp the structure of a task or situation without relying on detailed analytical tools. The correctness or falsity of intuition is determined not by intuition itself, but through subsequent cognitive testing and actions. However, it is intuition that allows quickly formulating a hypothesis or highlighting the essential features of concepts before their value becomes fully known. Feinberg identified three types of intuition (Fig. 1) (Tsybukh and Pyvovarchyk, 2021).

The first type of intuition, "intuition-guesswork", is marked by the ability to make logical leaps within complex sequences of correct reasoning, allowing a person to predict the result, which can then be confirmed by logical evidence. This type of intuition is often useful for solving problems quickly and accurately.

The second type of intuition is known as "intuition that discovers something new". This form of intuition introduces innovative ideas that may contradict established scientific concepts. It requires rethinking logical connections between phenomena.

The third type of intuition, "fundamental intuition", involves the directed identification of fundamental patterns in reality. This form of intuition allows understanding the essence of phenomena and processes without the need for consistent logical analysis. It promotes a deep understanding of complex facts and relationships, which can be important for further scientific research.

There is also a concept of "logical intuition", defined as the ability to automatically draw simple logical or probabilistic conclusions (Ghasemi et al., 2022; Moore and Demeyere, 2025). Individuals inclined toward intuitive thinking can quickly and imperceptibly draw such conclusions, which may be crucial at critical moments. It is important to note that intuitive skills rely on processing surface structural features that may coincidentally align with logical truth. Thus, although intuitive conclusions can influence a person's beliefs, they may not always be recognised as logical intuition.

Intuition influences decision-making by shaping preferences and approaches within the decision-making process. Intuitive decision-making is often marked by speed. This means that a person can quickly respond to a situation or solve a problem, favouring their first impressions or intuitive judgements. Intuition can help identify certain aspects of a situation that may be implicit or non-obvious. It can help draw on subconscious information or an intuitive sense when making a decision. Intuition can help a person to better understand a situation or problem, and identify aspects that cannot be accurately determined by logical analysis. Intuitive decisions are often based on personal beliefs, experiences, or intuitive feelings and may not always have explicit substantiation. This can be an advantage in situations where logical analysis is not informative enough. Intuition can promote creativity in decision-making, as it allows for the emergence of innovative ideas and approaches to problems.

Intuition, as an important element of human perception, plays a key role in understanding complex situations and making decisions (Chudnoff, 2013). It serves not only as a means of effective navigation in uncertain situations but also embodies important psychological and philosophical aspects, especially in the context of ethics and personal development. The ability to intuitively sense the right course of action can guide decisions that go beyond logic and validity. Moreover, intuition may act as a source of knowledge, especially when it interacts with rational thinking. Combining intuition with rational aspects of mental activity can create a unique approach to solving problems and achieving goals. Thus, intuition is defined not only as a means of orientation in difficult circumstances but also as a complex phenomenon that can enrich the psychological, philosophical, and ethical aspects of human life.

 DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

As a psychological process, intuition plays a key role in decision-making, especially in situations where logical thinking may be insufficient. This process serves as an effective tool for analysing and understanding situations in which it is important to make quick and efficient decisions (Hodgkinson and Sadler-Smith, 2011). Intuition is a valuable mental resource that can be useful in a variety of contexts. However, it is important to recognise that intuition is not always a reliable source of decision-making, and its effectiveness may vary depending on the situation. Therefore, intuitive solutions should be balanced with sound logical analysis.

MECHANISMS OF OCCURRENCE AND PERCEPTION OF THE FEELING OF DÉJÀ VU: A REVIEW FROM THE PERSPECTIVE OF INCORRECT RECONSTRUCTION OF EVENTS IN MEMORY

The sense of déjà vu – a feeling similar to intuitive perception – corresponds to the belief that the current situation, event, or place has already been experienced in the past, even when this is not possible from a logical standpoint. Déjà vu can occur in various states, including normal consciousness. Its origin is linked to psychological processes and specific human brain mechanisms. They can affect the overall mental state, producing certain experiences and impressions. These states have their own nature and arise through certain mental processes that underlie the perception and processing of information in the brain (O'Connor et al., 2021; Péron, 2024).

At an early age and with a limited amount of knowledge, a person relies on two basic emotional states: "Dissatisfaction" and "Pleasure" to evaluate incoming information. This assessment occurs automatically within the mental system. However, over time, as more data are processed, more complex emotions develop, and a multi-criteria emotional vector is created that reflects the multidimensional nature of emotional experience. These multi-criteria assessments are used to identify discrepancies between subjective knowledge models and the external environment (Ying et al., 2024). This discrepancy is estimated using a multi-criteria emotional vector, and reactions and responses to the environment are adjusted accordingly. This memory system helps explain the effect of déjà vu, when a person feels they have already seen or acted within the circumstances that unfold before them. The déjà vu effect occurs when new information is compared with already stored memory traces, and due to certain factors (for example, distraction or interference), there is no awareness of the novelty of the information. As a result, further comparison of such an image with previously stored information produces the sensation of déjà vu (Thomas and Tröster, 2024).

On a psychological level, déjà vu may arise from incorrect reconstruction of events in memory. Sometimes people confuse their memories or perceptions, which can give the impression that the current situation has already been experienced before. Certain areas of the brain, such as the hippocampus and parietal cortex, are involved in information perception and processing. When these neural networks are disrupted, distortions in the temporal sequence of events and perception may occur. The experience of déjà vu has a dual nature: it leaves a lasting imprint on the subject's mind, but at the same time instantly disappears. This feeling can be similar to a memorable event. Déjà vu is a strange and deeply disorienting phenomenon, but it also has a potentially restorative dimension, as it can transport a person to a different place and time (Barbagallo et al., 2025). It is very similar to the mechanism of perception of memories, and since many connections cannot be clearly defined, the expressions "there" and "here" are intertwined, with the present feeling similar to the past. In other words, the sense of belonging or ownership depends on the act of recognition and remembrance rather than a strict "relationship between oneself and the world". Therefore, the short duration of this experience is not particularly important (Eicher et al., 2025; Pearce, 2023).

The phenomenon of déjà vu is not yet fully understood from a psychological perspective, so it is worth considering several mechanisms that can explain its occurrence. One of the mechanisms of déjà vu is associated with possible disturbances in different types of memory, in particular with episodic memory (remembering specific events) and semantic memory (knowledge and facts). Blurring the distinction between these types of memory can lead to situations in which information that is usually stored in semantic memory is perceived as a specific event that has already occurred. Another mechanism is related to memory recovery. Déjà vu may arise when the memory of a particular event or moment is first activated in the brain, and the person perceives it as a feeling that they have already experienced this situation.

Interhemispheric interactions in the brain, especially between the right and left hemispheres, may play a key role in triggering feelings of déjà vu. This phenomenon occurs when one hemisphere perceives incoming information, and the other attempts to find relevant information in memory, creating the impression of prior experience. The mechanism of this phenomenon is linked to the perception and processing of information in different parts of the brain. Déjà vu can occur due to a delay in the perception of information, when one hemisphere receives signals earlier than the other. When the brain processes information with a temporal delay, the person may feel that they already have knowledge or experience about a similar situation (Messina et al., 2024). It is important to note that these mechanisms are only theoretical hypotheses, and the sensation of déjà vu remains a complex and not entirely clear area for scientific consideration. Further research aims to clarify these mechanisms and determine the influence of interhemispheric interaction on the occurrence of déjà vu.

There is also a close relationship between unpredictable autobiographical memories and déjà vu (Barzykowski and

DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036

Moulin, 2022). These phenomena may arise as a natural product of memory restoration, especially autobiographical memory, which includes memories of past events and personal experiences. Déjà vu, in contrast, is the feeling that the current situation or event has already been experienced before, even when this does not correspond to actual experience (Morand-Grondin et al., 2025). The occurrence of déjà vu may be associated with the unexpected restoration of autobiographical memories that affect the perception and interpretation of the present moment. The phenomenon of déjà vu is defined as a specific type of false perception, in which the present moment is perceived as if it had already taken place in the past (Mena-Contla et al., 2021). This may give the impression that the person has already been in a similar situation and has previous experience regarding the further development of events. Thus, the occurrence of déjà vu places the brain in a state of illusory similarity between current and past experiences, even when there is no real connection between them.

The study results revealed important links between altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the phenomenon of déjà vu, providing a better understanding of the mechanisms of their occurrence and their impact on human mental processes. The identified aspects of these phenomena may support the development of psychotherapeutic approaches aimed at stabilising the psycho-emotional state of patients. The results obtained can be applied in psychotherapy, where the use of self-regulation techniques, such as focusing on external stimuli or cognitive correction, may help patients experiencing altered states of consciousness adapt to reality and reduce the intensity of destructive symptoms. These findings may be valuable in educational processes, particularly for the development of intuitive thinking and self-awareness in students. Integrating self-awareness and emotional regulation techniques into educational programmes can improve cognitive skills and decision-making abilities. The application of these findings may also be important for cognitive training, as understanding the mechanisms of déjà vu and intuition enables the development of more effective training programmes targeting memory, attention, and emotional stability. All these aspects increase the practical value of the work, expanding its potential applications across various areas of practice, which can contribute to the development of both psychotherapeutic methods and educational and training programmes.

CONCLUSIONS

Altered states of consciousness, intuition, and the feeling of déjà vu influence human perception, cognition, and decision-making in distinct yet interconnected ways. Altered states can modify an individual's experience of time, space, emotions, and thoughts, often leading to insights and perceptions unavailable in ordinary consciousness. Intuition facilitates rapid, non-analytical decision-making, particularly in complex or ambiguous situations where rational analysis may be insufficient. The phenomenon of déjà vu, often linked to memory processes, creates a false sense of familiarity that can subtly shape one's interpretation of and response to the present moment. Collectively, these phenomena expand the boundaries of conscious experience and deepen one's interaction with the external world.

Within the framework of this study, the terminology associated with the concepts of "altered states of consciousness", "intuition", and "feelings of déjà vu" was thoroughly analysed. The study highlights exercises aimed at stabilising consciousness in situations where altered states occur, such as "5-4-3-2-1", "Radio", "Who Am I?", and "Visualisation". In addition, the study examines various aspects and types of intuition, including "intuition-guesswork", "intuition that discovers something new", and "fundamental intuition". The study found that the sensation of déjà vu may create the impression that a situation has already occurred, even though this is not the case. This can lead to confusion about time and events.

In the course of this study, it was found that the experience and perception of altered states of consciousness vary significantly between individuals, emphasising the subjectivity of these phenomena. This indicates that an individual approach to considering these phenomena is important for understanding them within the broader context of psychological and conscious processes. Intuition, in turn, manifests in various forms, encompassing intuition-guesswork which allows the anticipation of something new or unknown, and fundamental intuition. This variety of manifestations of intuition emphasises the versatility of this psychological phenomenon. Feelings of déjà vu likewise reveal their own unique aspects and characteristics for each individual, highlighting the individual nature of this phenomenon within the psychological dimension. The results emphasise the importance of an individual approach to studying and interpreting these phenomena in the context of psychological and mental processes. Identifying each person's individual characteristics and unique responses to altered states of consciousness, intuition, and feelings of déjà vu is a key aspect for a deeper understanding of these phenomena in a psychological context.

Future researchers are encouraged to explore the clinical aspects of altered states of consciousness, particularly their association with mental disorders or psychoactive substances, which can help develop effective treatment and prevention strategies.

Conflict of interest

The author does not report any financial or personal connections with other persons or organisations which might negatively affect the content of this publication and/or claim authorship rights to this publication.

Author contribution

Original concept of study; collection, recording and/or compilation of data; analysis and interpretation of data; writing of manuscript; critical review of manuscript; final approval of manuscript: LS.

References

Aftab A, Banicki K, Ruffalo ML et al.: Psychiatric diagnosis: a clinical guide to navigating diagnostic pluralism. J Nerv Ment Dis 2024; 212: 445–454.

Barbagallo F, Assenza MR, Messina A: In the brain of phosphodiesterases: potential therapeutic targets for schizophrenia. Clin Psychopharmacol Neurosci 2025; 23: 15–31.

Barzykowski K, Moulin C: Are involuntary autobiographical memory and déjà vu natural products of memory retrieval? Behav Brain Sci 2022; 46: e356.

Bezverkhy O: Altered states of consciousness in modern practical psychology. In: Individuality in Psychological Dimensions of Communities and Professions: Collection of Scientific Works. Alfa-PIK LLC, Kyiv 2020: 227–231.

Chudnoff E: Intuition. Oxford University Press, Oxford 2013.

Cleary AM, Brown AS: The Déjà Vu Experience. Routledge, New York 2021.

Coco GL, Melchiori F, Oieni V et al.: Group treatment for substance use disorder in adults: a systematic review and meta-analysis of randomized-controlled trials. J Subst Abuse Treat 2019; 99: 104–116.

Cofré R, Herzog R, Mediano PA et al.: Whole-brain models to explore altered states of consciousness from the bottom up. Brain Sci 2020; 10: 626.

Donets OB: The phenomenon of intuition in human cognitive activity: the essence and mechanisms of its action. In: The 12th International Scientific and Practical Conference "World Science: Problems, Prospects and Innovations". Perfect Publishing, Toronto 2021: 293–301.

Dufynets V, Shcherban T, Hoblyk V et al.: Psychological assistance to civilians in the context of the negative impact of war: the problem of improving legislation. Soc Leg Stud 2024; 7: 242–254.

Dykha M, Lukianova V, Polozova V et al.: Transformation of Ukraine's socio-economic development in the context of global turbulence and war: challenges and opportunities. Sci Bull Mukach State Univ Series Econ 2024; 11: 30–41.

Efremov A: The fear primacy hypothesis in the structure of emotional states: a systematic literature review. Psychol Rep 2025a: 332941241313106.

Efremov A: The psychology of faith and religious identity: how theology shapes worldview and self-perception. Pharos J Theol 2025b; 106: 1–15.

Eicher M, Johannessen R, Jokeit H: Social neuropsychology of epilepsy in the digital age: a narrative review on challenges and opportunities. Epilepsy Behav 2025; 166: 110336.

Fletcher AM: Inside Rehab: The Surprising Truth About Addiction Treatment – and How to Get Help That Works. Penguin Books, London 2013.

Ghasemi O, Handley S, Howarth S et al.: Logical intuition is not really about logic. J Exp Psychol Gen 2022; 151: 2009–2028.

Halych YV: Peculiarities of rehabilitation of persons with addiction to psychoactive substances. Leg Psychol 2022; 1: 64–73.

Hodgkinson GP, Sadler-Smith E: Investigating intuition: beyond self-report. In: Sinclair M (ed.): Handbook of Intuition Research. Edward Elgar Publishing, Cheltenham 2011: 52–66.

Mena-Contla A, Morales-Lara L, Peña-Moreno R et al.: Origin of "déjà vu" phenomenon in the framework of the Fermi–Pasta–Ulam problem in nonautonomous systems. Optik 2021; 246: 167772.

Messina A, Bella F, Maccarone G et al.: Neutrophil–lymphocyte ratio values in schizophrenia: a comparison between oral and long-acting antipsychotic therapies. Brain Sci 2024; 14: 602.

Moore MJ, Demeyere N: Registered reports in neuropsychology: insights from the burning houses study. Cortex 2025; 190: 155–159.

Morand-Grondin D, Berthod J, Sigouin J et al.: Paving the road for more ethical and equitable policies and practices in telerehabilitation in psychology and neuropsychology: protocol for a rapid review. JMIR Res Protoc 2025; 14: e66639.

Moses Ige K, Krivins A, Vilks A et al.: Legal framework for health policy to reduce the level of substance abuse in the United States. Soc Leg Stud 2024; 7: 178–189.

Mukhammedov M, Nizamov A, Mukhammedova Z et al.: Development of public regulatory strategies to incentivise investment in human capital. Sci Bull Mukach State Univ Series Econ 2024; 11: 133–146.

Nazarova H, Stepanova E, Achkasova O et al.: Analysis of tools for evaluating the effectiveness of the personnel adaptation system in the context of the social entrepreneurship. Econ Develop 2024; 23: 42–55.

Nibbio G, Calzavara-Pinton I, Barlati S et al.: Well-being and mental health: where do we stand after COVID-19 pandemic? J Nerv Ment Dis 2025; 213: 28–33.

O'Connor AR, Wells C, Moulin CJ: Déjà vu and other dissociative states in memory. Memory 2021; 29: 835–842.

Overgaard M, Overgaard R: Neural correlates of contents and levels of consciousness. Front Psychol 2010; 1: 164.

Pearce L: Finding one place in another: post/phenomenology, memory and *déjà vu*. Soc Cult Geogr 2023; 24: 195–211.

Péron JA: Challenges and prospects in advancing clinical neuropsychology. Cortex 2024; 179: 261–270.

Perrin D, Moulin CJ, Sant'Anna A: Déjà vécu is not déjà vu: an ability view. Philos Psychol 2024; 37: 2466–2496.

Preller KH, Razi A, Zeidman P et al.: Effective connectivity changes in LSD-induced altered states of consciousness in humans. Proc Natl Acad Sci U S A 2019; 116: 2743–2748.

Thomas JA, Tröster AI: Neuropsychology and movement disorders. Neurol Clin 2024; 42: 821–833.

Tsybukh LM, Pyvovarchyk IM: Peculiarities of the relationship between intelligence and intuition. In: Pedagogical and Psychological Sciences: Patterns and Trends of Development. Baltija Publishing, Riga 2021: 386–401.

Ying H, Pranolo A, Nuryana Z et al.: Emerging trends in the evolution of neuropsychology and artificial intelligence: a comprehensive analysis. Telemat Infromatics Rep 2024; 16: 100171.

Zaika VM: The use of self-regulation techniques in the provision of psychological first aid in altered states of consciousness. In: Materials of the All-Ukrainian Scientific and Practical Conference with International Participation "Emergency and Urgent Care in Ukraine: Organizational, Legal, Clinical Aspects". Poltava State Medical University, Poltava 2023: 26–29.

Zotaj A, Krasniqi M, Bara R et al.: Assessment of the economic value of physiotherapy treatment for economically effective results. Econ Develop 2024; 23: 104–114.

DOI: 10.15557/PiPK.2026.0036